



Presented by The High End

CARDBOARD FIRE TRUCK CAB

Life-Size Sit-In Fire Truck — Dashboard, Steering Wheel & Helmet

Build the fire truck. Wear the helmet. Save the living room.

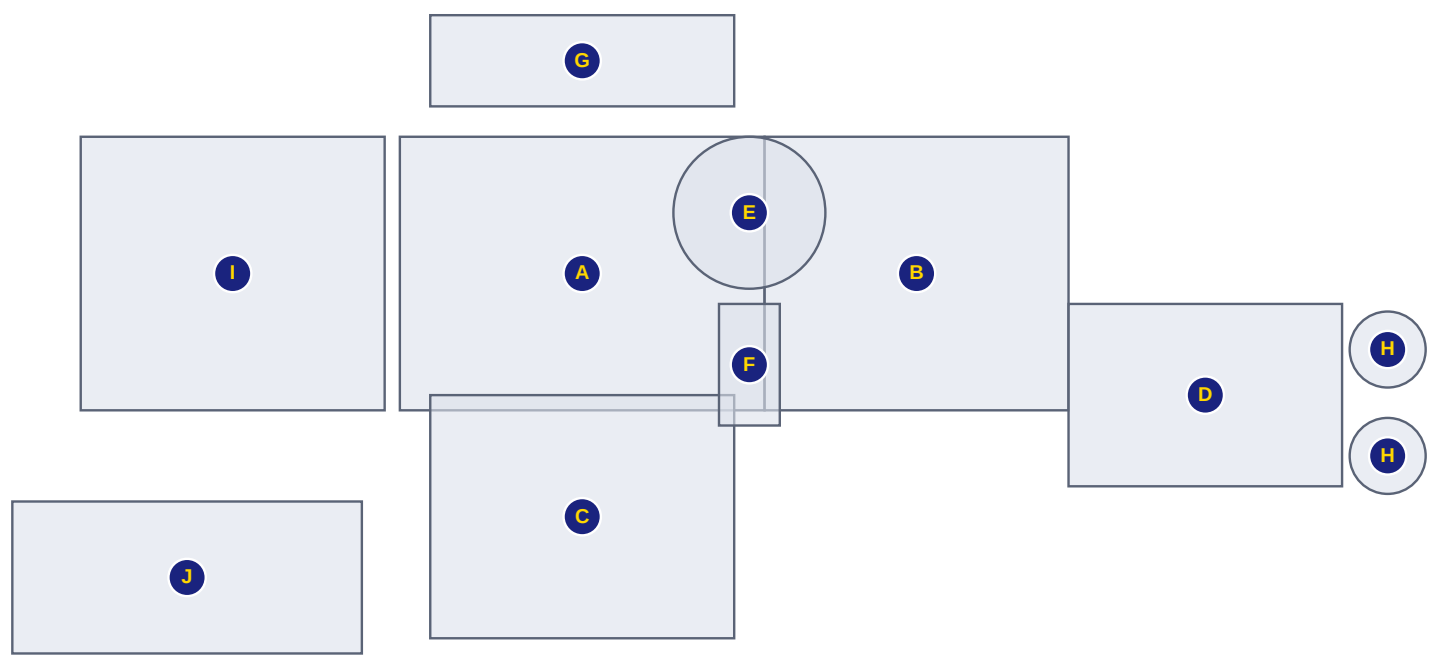
AGES 4+	BOXES 2–3 Large Boxes	TIME 90 Minutes	DIFF Beginner *	PIECES 10 pcs
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CARDBOARD NEEDED:
2–3 Large Boxes (at least 24" × 36" (61 × 91 cm) each)

MISSION GOAL:
Build a sit-in fire truck cab with windshield, steering wheel, dashboard, light bar, hood — plus a wearable firefighter helmet. All exterior painted fire engine red.

HOW IT ALL GOES TOGETHER — CARDBOARD FIRE TRUCK CAB

The finished build, side view, with every part in the place the steps put it and the letter from its own cut-template page. Parts are drawn at their real size relative to each other, so if a letter is on this picture there is a page for it in this file. Pieces that roll into a tube are shown rolled, not laid flat.



EVERY PART IN THIS BUILD				
A	CAB SIDE PANEL 24" × 18" (61 × 46 cm)	CUT ×2	B	FRONT WINDSHIELD PANEL 20" × 18" (51 × 46 cm) CUT ×1
C	CAB FLOOR / SEAT BASE 20" × 16" (51 × 41 cm)	CUT ×1	D	HOOD EXTENSION 18" × 12" (46 × 30 cm) CUT ×1
E	STEERING WHEEL (CIRCLE) 10" × 10" (25 × 25 cm)	CUT ×2	F	STEERING COLUMN 4" × 8" (10 × 20 cm) CUT ×1
G	LIGHT BAR (ROOF STRIP) 20" × 6" (51 × 15 cm)	CUT ×1	H	HEADLIGHT CIRCLE 5" × 5" (13 × 13 cm) CUT ×2
I	REAR PANEL 20" × 18" (51 × 46 cm)	CUT ×1	J	HELMET WRAP 23" × 10" (58 × 25 cm) CUT ×1

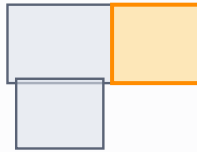
BUILD SEQUENCE — WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE AFTER EACH STEP

Each picture is the build once that step is finished. The part you just added is the ORANGE one. Grey is what was already there. Work down the page and yours should look like each picture in turn.

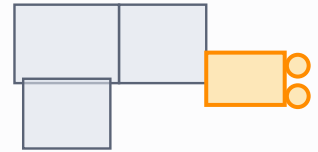
1 BUILD THE CAB BOX



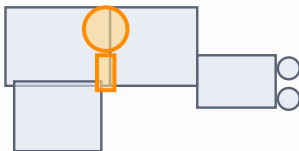
2 ADD THE WINDSHIELD



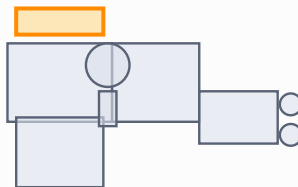
3 BUILD THE HOOD



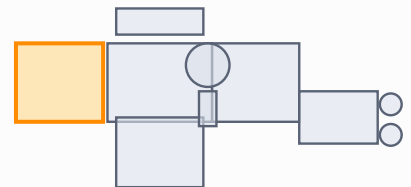
4 BUILD THE STEERING WHEEL



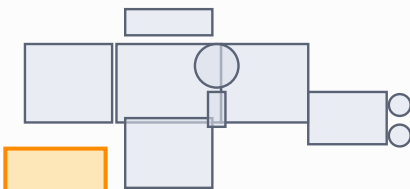
6 MOUNT THE LIGHT BAR



7 CLOSE THE REAR PANEL



9 BUILD THE HELMET

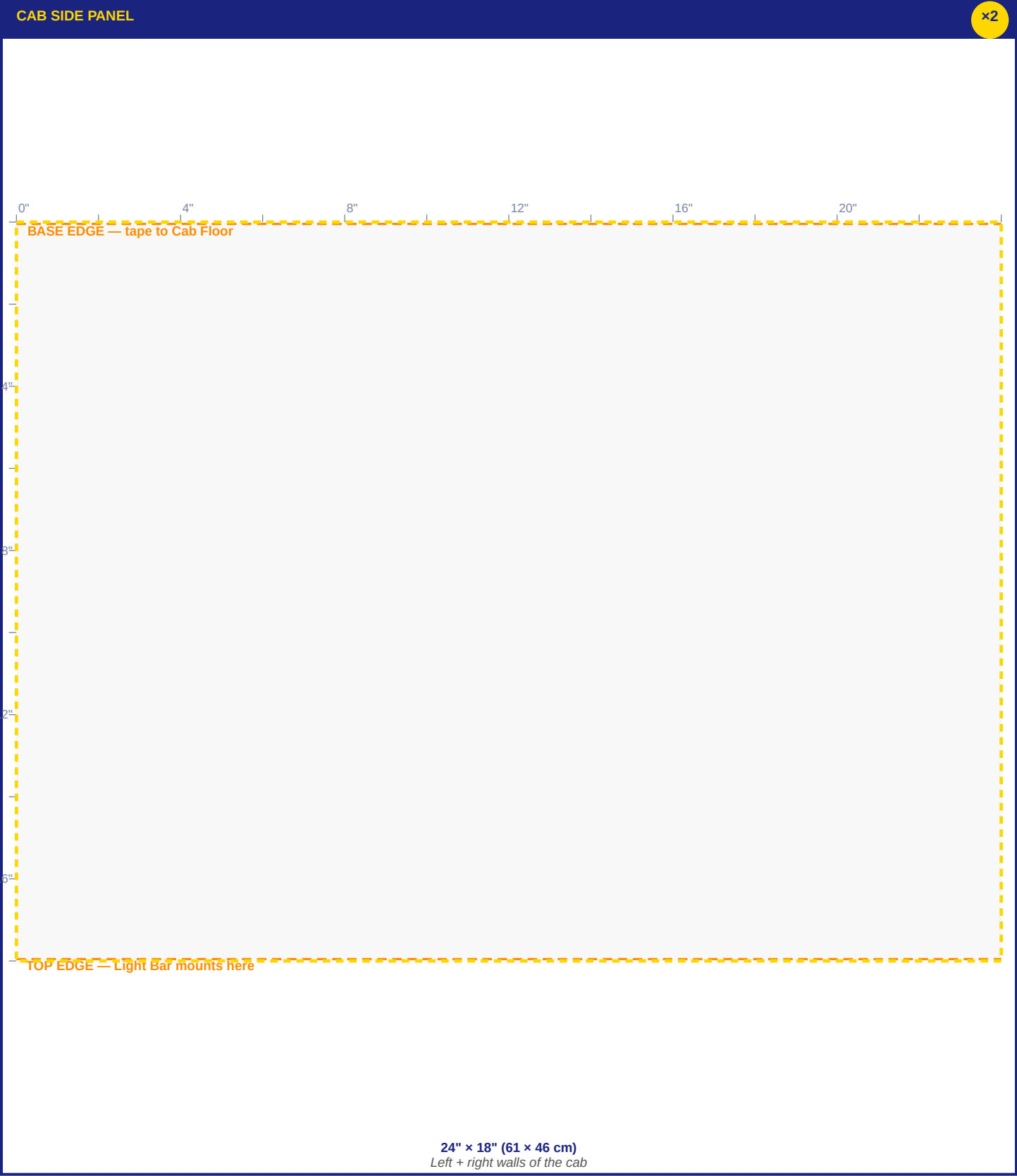




CAB SIDE PANEL

24" × 18" (61 × 46 cm) | Cut ×2

CUT
x2



MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

FOLD — score lightly, then fold at this line

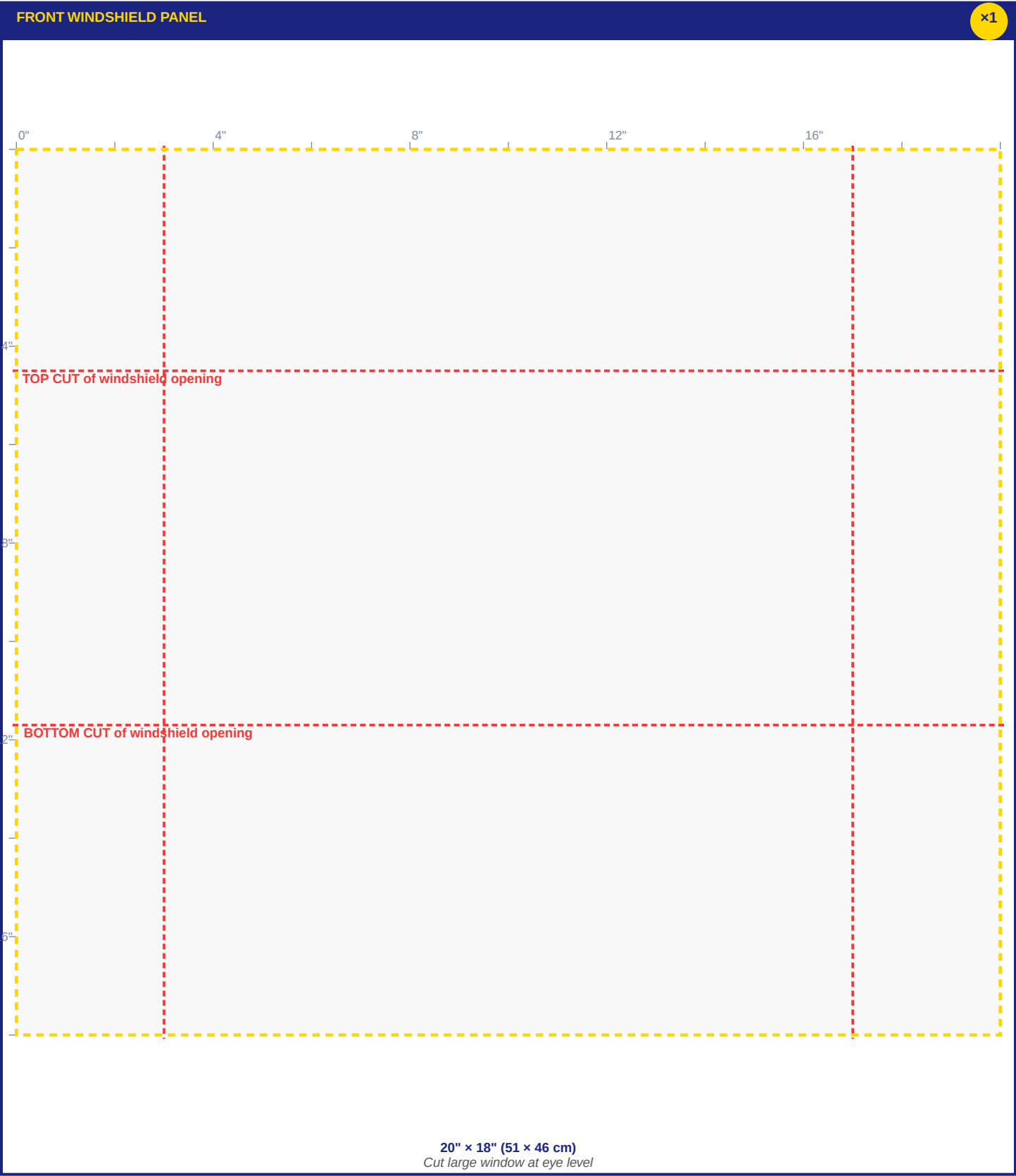
NOTE: Left + right walls of the cab



FRONT WINDSHIELD PANEL

20" × 18" (51 × 46 cm) | Cut ×1

CUT
x1



MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

CUT — scissors or box cutter on this line

NOTE: Cut large window at eye level



CAB FLOOR / SEAT BASE

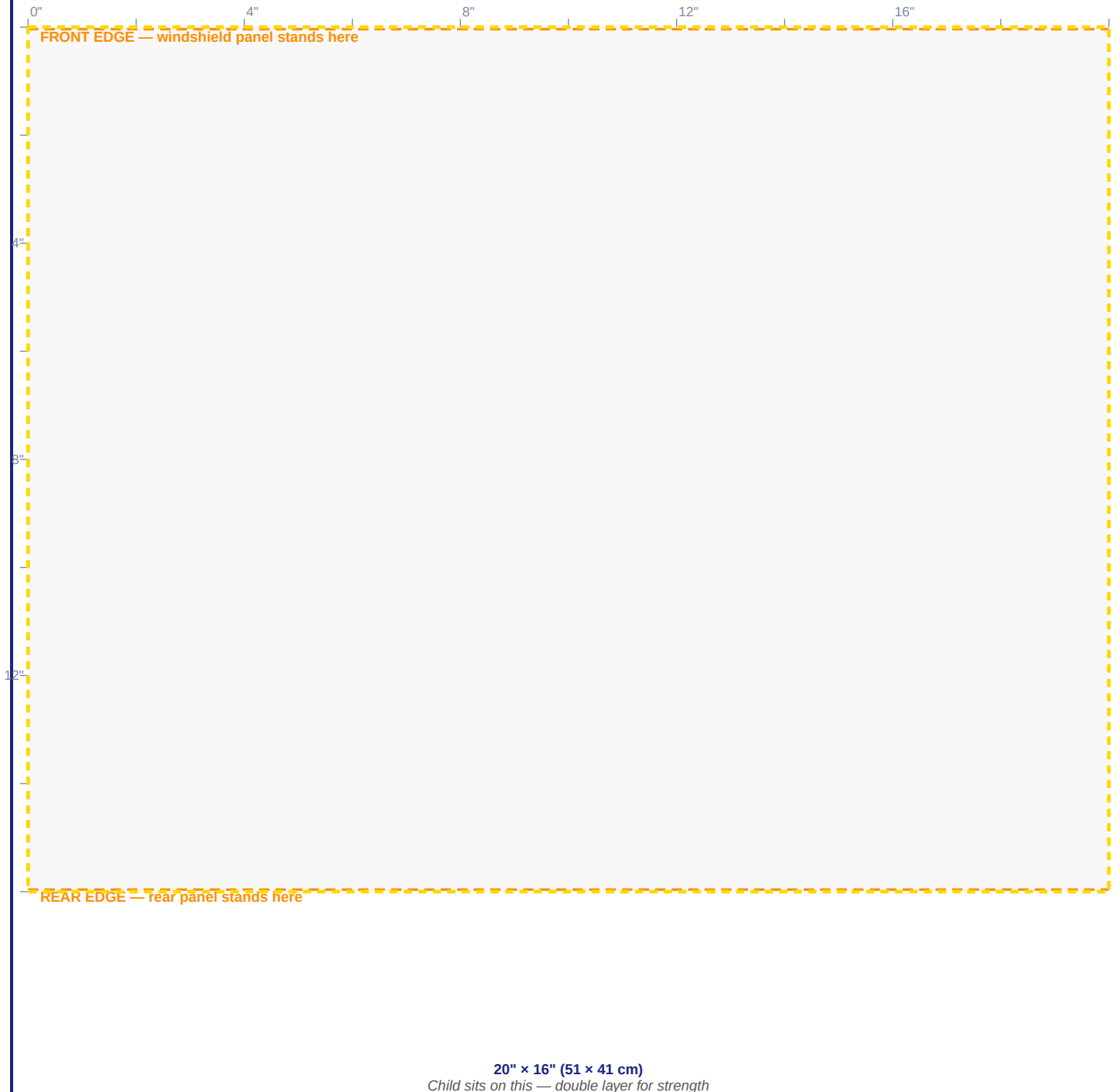
20" × 16" (51 × 41 cm) | Cut ×1

CUT

x1

CAB FLOOR / SEAT BASE

x1



MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

FOLD — score lightly, then fold at this line

NOTE: Child sits on this — double layer for strength



HOOD EXTENSION

18" x 12" (46 x 30 cm) | Cut x1

CUT
x1

HOOD EXTENSION

0"4"8"12"16"

FOLD EDGE attaches to bottom of windshield

SCORE MIDLINE — angled down slightly for hood slope

18" x 12" (46 x 30 cm)
Angles forward from base of windshield

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

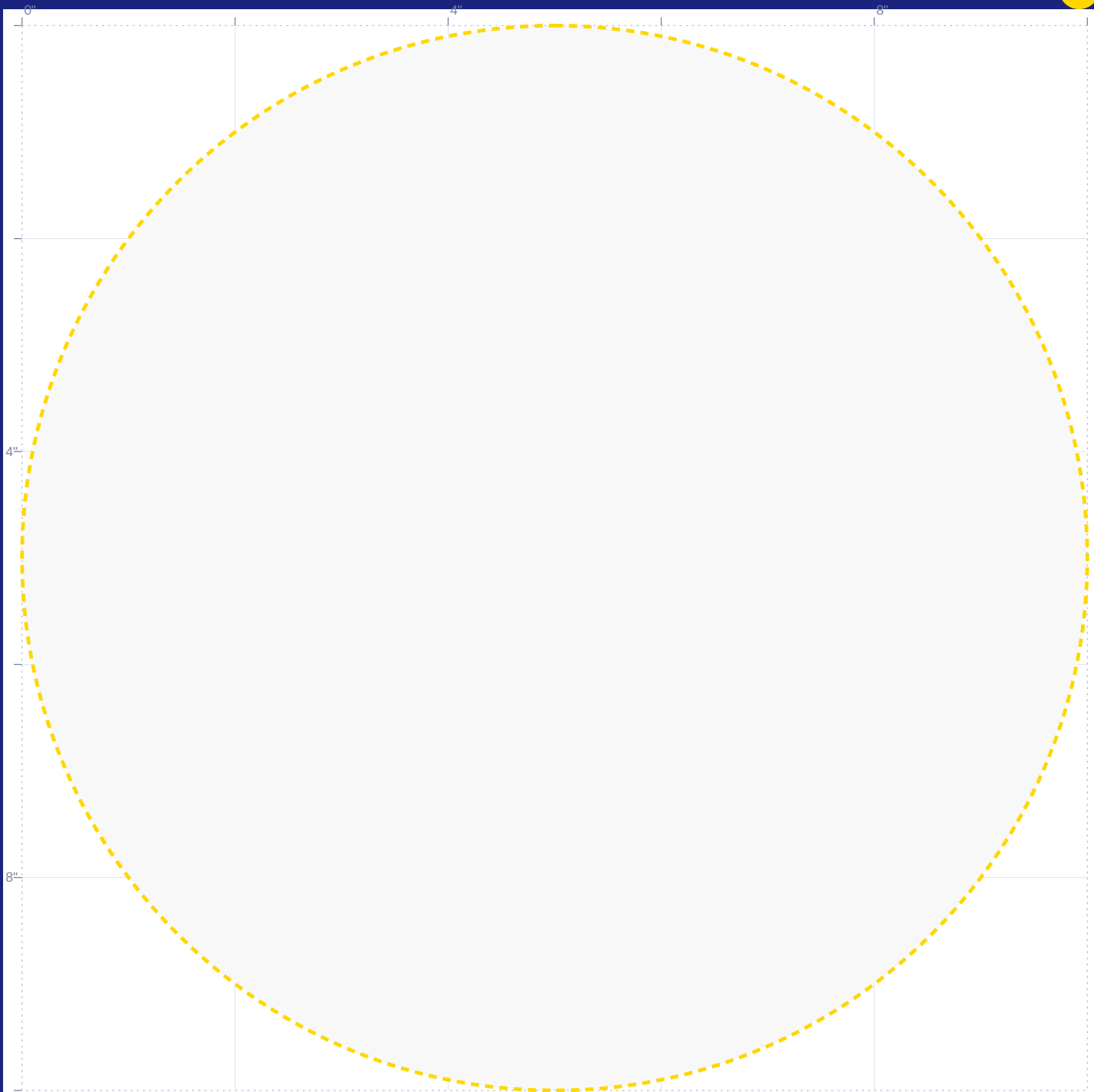
FOLD — score lightly, then fold at this line

SCORE — press hard with ruler but do NOT cut through

NOTE: Angles forward from base of windshield

STEERING WHEEL (CIRCLE)

x2

**HOW TO DRAW THIS SHAPE ON YOUR CARDBOARD:**

A circle 10" across. Trace a plate or a bowl, or pin a string 5" from the centre and swing a pencil right round. Cut two and stack them for rigidity.

Cut along the GOLD dashed outline. The faint grey box is the flat piece of cardboard it comes from; the grid squares are 2".

10" × 10" (25 × 25 cm)
Circle

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

GOLD OUTLINE — this is the shape you cut. It is NOT a rectangle.

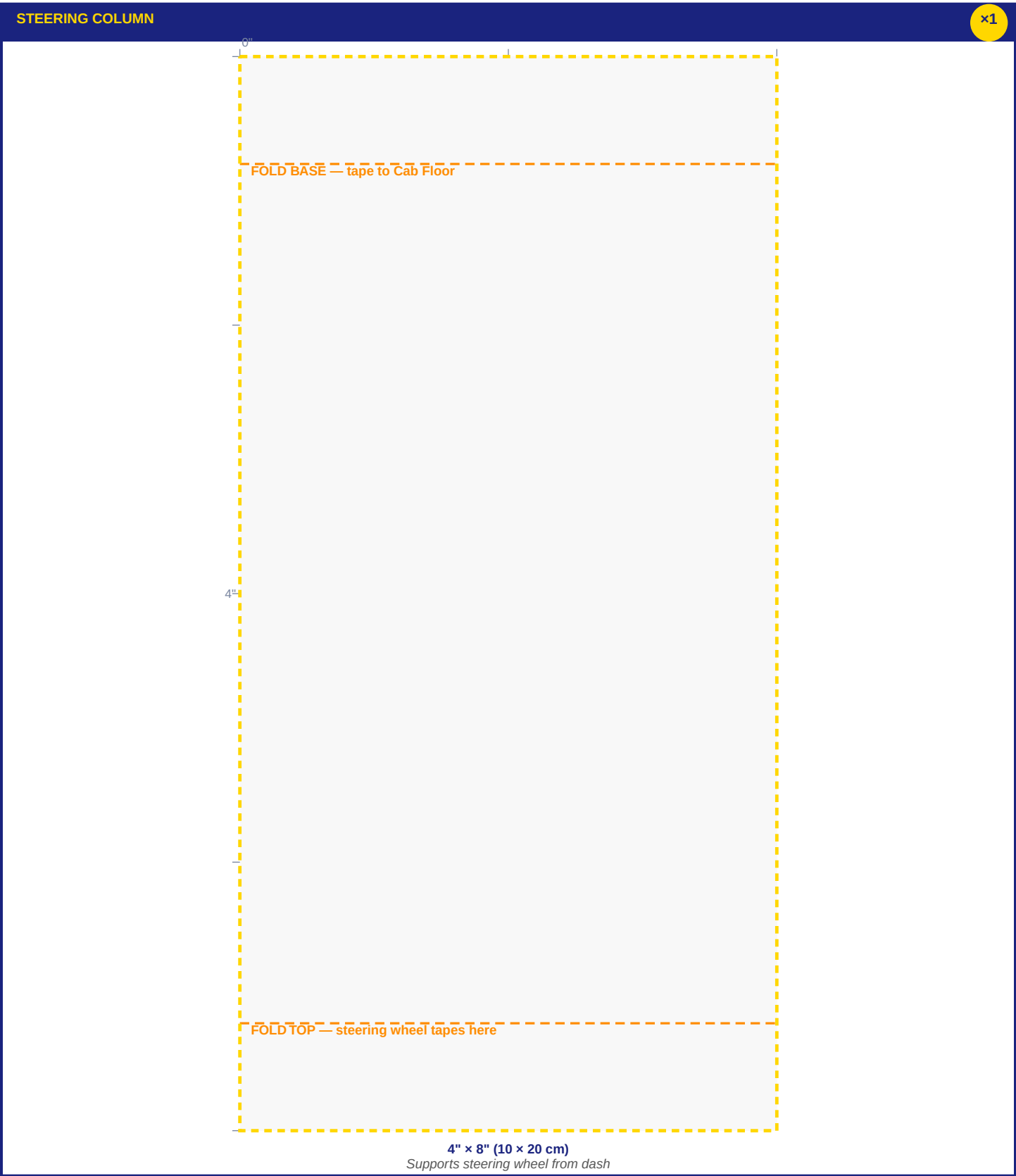
NOTE: Stack both circles for thickness



STEERING COLUMN

4" x 8" (10 x 20 cm) | Cut x1

CUT
x1



MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

FOLD — score lightly, then fold at this line

NOTE: Supports steering wheel from dash



LIGHT BAR (ROOF STRIP)

20" x 6" (51 x 15 cm) | Cut x1

CUT
x1

LIGHT BAR (ROOF STRIP)

x1

0" 4" 8" 12" 16"

EDGE — folds over cab top to attach

4"

20" x 6" (51 x 15 cm)

Mount on top of cab — draw red/blue lights

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

FOLD — score lightly, then fold at this line

NOTE: Mount on top of cab — draw red/blue lights



HEADLIGHT CIRCLE

5" × 5" (13 × 13 cm) | Cut ×2

CUT
x2

HEADLIGHT CIRCLE

HOW TO DRAW THIS SHAPE ON YOUR CARDBOARD:
A circle 5" across. Trace the bottom of a cup or a roll of tape.

Cut along the GOLD dashed outline. The faint grey box is the flat piece of cardboard it comes from; the grid squares are 2".

5" × 5" (13 × 13 cm)
Circle

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

GOLD OUTLINE — this is the shape you cut. It is NOT a rectangle.

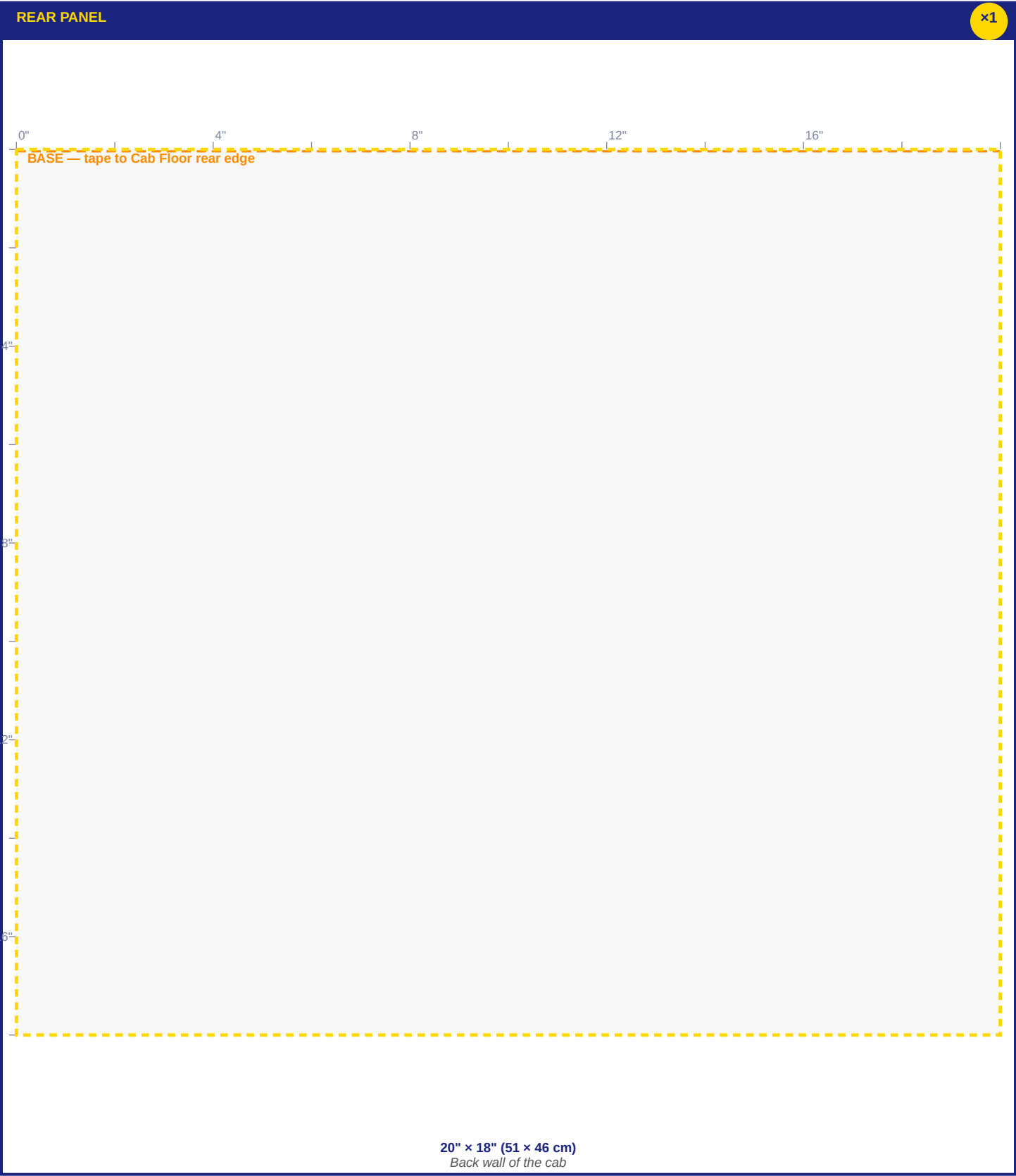
NOTE: Glue to front corners of hood



REAR PANEL

20" × 18" (51 × 46 cm) | Cut ×1

CUT
x1



MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

FOLD — score lightly, then fold at this line

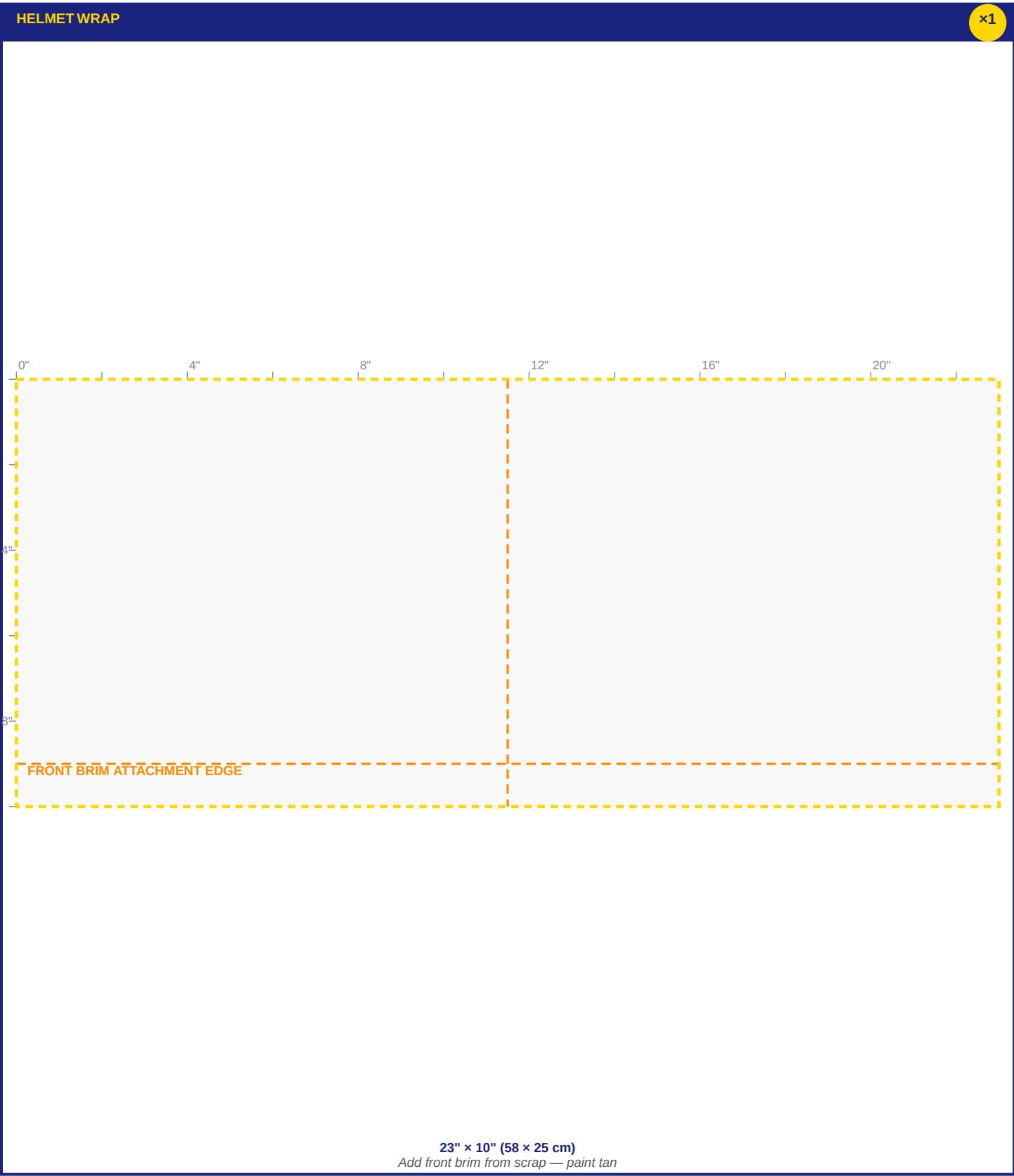
NOTE: Back wall of the cab



HELMET WRAP

23" x 10" (58 x 25 cm) | Cut x1

CUT
x1



MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

FOLD — score lightly, then fold at this line

NOTE: Add front brim from scrap — paint tan

WHAT YOU NEED — CARDBOARD FIRE TRUCK CAB

CARDBOARD PIECES — 10 TOTAL (2–3 Large Boxes (at least 24" × 36" (61 × 91 cm) each))

×2 Cab Side Panel 24" × 18" <i>Left + right walls of the cab</i>	×1 Steering Column 4" × 8" <i>Supports steering wheel from dash</i>
×1 Front Windshield Panel 20" × 18" <i>Cut large window at eye level</i>	×1 Light Bar (roof strip) 20" × 6" <i>Mount on top of cab — draw red/blue lights</i>
×1 Cab Floor / Seat Base 20" × 16" <i>Child sits on this — double layer for strength</i>	×2 Headlight Circle 5" × 5" <i>Glue to front corners of hood</i>
×1 Hood Extension 18" × 12" <i>Angles forward from base of windshield</i>	×1 Rear Panel 20" × 18" <i>Back wall of the cab</i>
×2 Steering Wheel (circle) 10" × 10" <i>Stack both circles for thickness</i>	×1 Helmet Wrap 23" × 10" <i>Add front brim from scrap — paint tan</i>

TOOLS & SUPPLIES

- | | |
|-------------------------------|---|
| + 2–3 large cardboard boxes | + RED PAINT (most important — entire exterior is fire engine red) |
| + Box cutter — ADULT USE ONLY | + Black + yellow markers for dashboard |
| + Heavy scissors for kids | + Tan/brown paint for helmet |
| + Packing tape (2+ rolls) | |

FUN FACT!

Real fire trucks pump 500 gallons of water per minute. Yours pumps 0 — but the bravery is the same.

CHALLENGE!

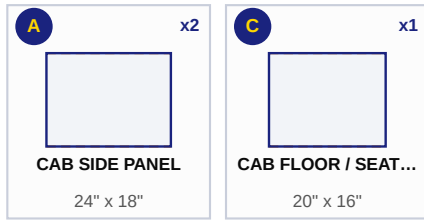
Fire drill! Set a 60-second timer. Can the whole family get to the fire truck and buckle in before the alarm goes off?

1

STEP 1: BUILD THE CAB BOX

Lay the Cab Floor flat (fold marks show where walls attach). Stand both Side Panels upright on left and right of the floor. Tape all inside seams with 3+ layers. This is the shell your child sits inside.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP



2

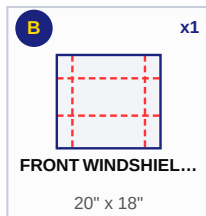
STEP 2: ADD THE WINDSHIELD

! ADULT ASSIST NEEDED

Tape the Front Windshield Panel upright at the front. Cut the windshield opening using the 4 cut lines shown on the template — top cut, bottom cut, left cut, right cut. Keep solid frame around all 4 sides. This is what the driver looks through.

SAFETY: Adult cuts all 4 window cut lines. Smooth edges — no sharp points.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP

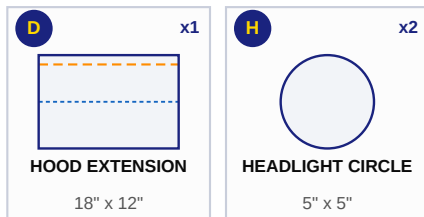


3

STEP 3: BUILD THE HOOD

Attach the Hood Extension at the base of the windshield using the fold mark. Score the midline (score mark on template) so the hood angles slightly downward. Attach a Headlight Circle to each front corner.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP



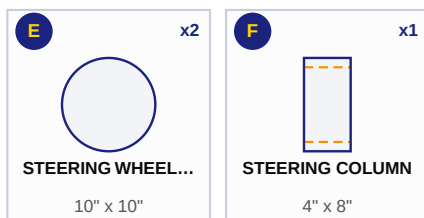
4

STEP 4: BUILD THE STEERING WHEEL

Cut both Steering Wheel circles (circle mark on template — trace a plate). Stack them and tape together for double thickness. Tape the Steering Column to the back of the wheel, then mount the whole assembly inside the cab at chest height when seated.

SAFETY: Steering wheel must not block the child's exit from the cab.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP

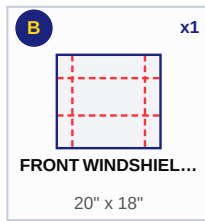


5

STEP 5: DRAW THE DASHBOARD

On the inside of the windshield panel below the window, draw a full dashboard — dials, gauges, a radio, a siren switch, a speedometer. The more detail, the better the build.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP

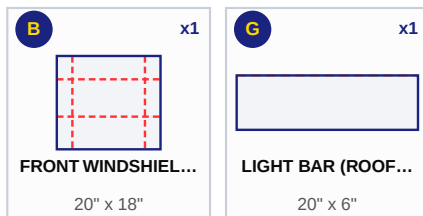


6

STEP 6: MOUNT THE LIGHT BAR

Tape the Light Bar across the top of the windshield panel (fold mark on template). Draw alternating red and blue light shapes across it. This is the emergency light bar — the most important outside detail.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP

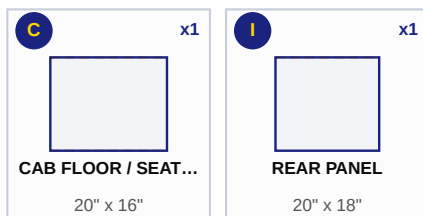


7

STEP 7: CLOSE THE REAR PANEL

Tape the Rear Panel upright at the back of the cab floor. The child should now sit inside an enclosed cab with an open top.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP



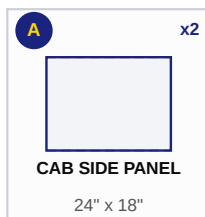
8

STEP 8: PAINT FIRE ENGINE RED

Paint the ENTIRE exterior fire engine red — every outside surface. This is the single most critical step. Add HEE FIRE DEPT or a badge number on the door. Add a flame logo on the side panel.

SAFETY: Water-based paint only in a ventilated space.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP



9

STEP 9: BUILD THE HELMET

Score the center of the Helmet Wrap so it curves. Wrap it around the child's head, overlap the ends about 1 inch, trim the extra and tape the side seam. Cut a front brim from scrap cardboard (attachment mark on template). Paint tan or brown. This is the helmet in the cover photo.

SAFETY: Confirm child can see clearly and breathe with helmet on.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP



10

STEP 10: QUALITY CHECK

Child sits at the steering wheel. Full red paint outside. Light bar on top. Firefighter helmet on. Compare to cover photo. That's the standard.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP



QUALITY CHECK!

Does your build match the cover photo? Compare side by side before you call it done.

"Build It. Own It." — Tatum & Kash Cardboard Creations